OEKO-TEX® Association

General Manager Meeting

30th – 31st October 2025, Copenhagen

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1 Overview

Meeting subject	General Manager Meeting
Date & Time	30. – 31.10.2025, Copenhagen
Participants live	Aitex: Vicente Blanes Julia (VB)
	Centexbel: Pol Lombaert (PL)
	Centrocot: Dr. Grazia Cerini (GC)
	Citeve: Braz Costa (BC)
	DTNW: Prof. Dr. Jochen Gutmann
	DTI: Johnny Rodam (JR)
	FILK: Prof. Dr. Haiko Schulz (HS)
	Hohenstein: Prof. Dr. Stefan Mecheels (SM), Dr. Stefan Droste (SDr)
	IFTH: Laurence Petitpierre (LP)
	Innovatext: Dr. Lívia Kokas Palicska (LK)
	Lukasiewicz-LIT: Dr. Ing. Renata Żyłła
	Mirtec: Kelly Stathopoulou (KS)
	Nissenken: Toshiaki Yamazaki (TY)
	OETI: Robert Löcker (RL), Matthias Schwetzel
	RISE: Lene Jul Östblom (LÖ)
	Shirley: Stephen Donnelly (SDo)
	STFI: Dr. Heike Illing-Günther
	TESTEX: Rainer Roten (RR), Dr. Jean-Pierre Haug (JH), Matz Bachmann (MB)
	OEKO-TEX®: Dr. Alfred J. Beerli (AB), Inga Bleyer (IB), Carolin Franitza (CF), Devendra Gupta (DG), Fanny Racine (FR), Elisa Rimmele (ER)
Participants online	
Absentees	Umweltlabor ACB: Melanie Dieckmann
Author	OEKO-TEX®: Inga Bleyer (IB), Carolin Franitza (CF), Devendra Gupta (DG), Fanny Racine (FR), Elisa Rimmele (ER)

2 Welcome & General Updates

Dr Alfred J Beerli, officially welcomes all people present and gives a note of thanks to Johnny Rodam from DTI for inviting us into to Copenhagen and for the organisation of the 2025 OEKO-TEX® General Manager meeting. AB welcomed the new General Managers to the group. He thanked all members of the OEKO-TEX® association for the good cooperation and fruitful discussions of the past year.

The meeting was opened, 30th October 9:00 am.

3 Organisation

OEKO-TEX® has 34 employees (29FT employees) as of October 2025.

4 Minutes: General Manager Meeting 2024

No comments were made concerning the minutes of last year´s General Manager Meeting in Alcoy (24th – 25th October 2024) and therefore they are accepted as being sent out.

5 Annual Report 2024/2025

Alfred J. Beerli challenged the General Managers regarding the low number of BHive users within the STeP certification.
No comments were made by the General Managers.

6 Finances

Please see the presentation slide 10 -13 for details.
In the financial year 2024/2025 was very successful and effective year, with revenue increasing and costs decreasing.

Costs details: AB remarked that the Association is ready and prepared for the future.

According to the tax rules and agreement with Zurich City, the reimbursement for 2024 / 2025 to all institutes is growing according to slide 12.

7 IT Roadmap

Please see the presentation slide 15 – 19 for details:

OEKO-TEX® Core training:

Every institute needs to provide at least one power user by early January 2026 to start with train the trainer session. The goal is to have trainings for all institute users done by the power user for the new OEKO-TEX® Core mid-2026.

OEKO-TEX® Connect training:

The training will start as well mid-2026. Institutes need to prepare manpower for the training.

General questions on the IT roadmap:

RL. How many testing and training hours are required by the institute. Please provided information as soon as possible, even if only estimates.

AB: We are working on a training plan that will be shared soon. The institute needs to determine how many people need to be involved.

AB: Training is starting as well for all (incl. external) in the second half of 2026.

Agreement:

It was agreed, to establish more frequent communication and meetings towards the GM with next steps as well about training information & dates.

Online Application:

AB: Online application is not part of the current scope. Online application needs to be aligned across all institutes, more alignment work needs to be done before. The application process is not defined.

More than 4 institutes are working on an online application prototype system.

SDr: Implement a working group to define an online application process

SDo: Shirley is happy to work with the same methodology / logic as the future OEKO-TEX® process, but not the same system to avoid double work. An API needs to be implemented.

Agreement:

It was agreed to establish a working group with all institutes presents for the Online application process.

8 Legislation Update

Please see the presentation slide 21 -23 for details:

EU EmpCo directive:

Customer inquiries and pressure have increased recently. A formal statement for customers is already in place. If any customer questions arise, please contact the OEKO-TEX® offices for support.

Independency:
SDr: Standard stetting and testing need to be separated in two organisation / companies. Standard setting involvement needs to be separate from operation (testing).
This concerns TESTEX and HOHENSTEIN.

SDr: As of now, we are supposing no change in the franchise contract will need to happen.
AB, RR: confirm the statement from SDr.
SDr: suggested to verify the independency of OEKO-TEX® with an external company like kpmg. This approach could strengthen the independency in front of the law, but it could be a second step.
AB: We keep you updated on the next steps.

DPP:

BC: DPP is a business opportunity for OEKO-TEX®. The association needs to understand the implications of DPP for the industry and supply chain.

Regulatory Landscape:

GC: We need an official position of OEKO-TEX® for all legal topics to participate in national WGs. It is important to align on positions and have one voice as OEKO- TEX®.

AB: Cedric is preparing an overview to evaluate the effects on our standards.

9 Portfolio Statistics

The last business year was a successful year for OEKO-TEX®.

Further details can be found in the presentation.

10 Strategic Discussion

Please see the presentation for the Miro survey results – slide 28 – 36

VB: How to increase the number of STeP in the market? With the result to increase the number of MADE IN GREEN labels on products.

AB: We need to change STeP to increase the numbers of STeP certificates!

11 Key Point Discussion

AB: Key points covered, no comments.
AB: 1 missing fair play signature is missing, and Alfred will follow up with the institute.

SDr from Hohenstein proposed 5 key discussion point:

1. Textile Genesis proposal:
   AB: Communication improvement needed for with the textile genesis, going forward better alignment and approach to be developed.
   GC: How can I get my supply chain to move from GOTS.
   SDr: CB control from GOTS is missing and hence our system is better; we will have to pitch the companies about the benefits of the system.

BC: value prop. of ORGANIC COTTON, GOTS claims what are those? Our competitive edge.
VB: Can Textile Genesis be used for STANDARD 100?
SDr: Review before extension of Textile Genesis next year.

Agreement:
Textile Genesis is ok to proceed.

2. Limit value topic:

P&G: Proposal to create a knowledge base for all association members and create a comprehensive tox-review
MB: AI development – MVP knowledge base via. Old data and lab reports.

Agreement:
OEKO-TEX® team to lead it.

3. Certification without testing:

SDr: certificates growing without testing growth is very high and the suggestion is that we - 1 min. spot check on OEKO-TEX® cert. Even if all components are pre-certified.
Cross checking certification data – once the new certification is in place.
Marketing and customer risk: in terms of narrative from communication perspective and ensuring that it is put forward
RL: The proposal makes sense as we don't have transaction verification
RR: Setting up clear rules about the entitlement about base certificates. Plus, OEKO-TEX® auditors should make it mandatory to check
SDr: Guidebook group: determines the process and the pricing going forward.
BC: customer who buys pre-certified materials will be conflicted about the integrity of our system, instead we should focus on the companies where we see failed tests and perform tests and audits there, to safeguard loyal and ethical customers. Incentive: for upstream partners to be worked upon.

Vote: 4 votes against and rest onboard.

Agreement: Guidebook working group to come up with the process and the pricing.

4. Pricing proposal:

Multiple suggestions were made, such as increase certification cost and reduce test cost and figure. Out how it impacts the customer and investigate the how this can play out.
GC: Pricing test cost diff. How do we gen. value for the customer? And what is the incentive to remain OEKO-TEX® certified?

Agreement: OEKO-TEX® takes the lead to develop this further.

5. ECO PASSPORT discussion:

   JP: based on product based and substance-based model.
   To investigate the pricing and made an enterprise model for big ones so that we can work on the pricing
   We must move this forward fast.

   Agreement: OEKO-TEX® works with the working group to further develop this.

12 Reports of the Institutes

(Alphabetical order)

12.1 AITEX

OEKO-TEX® numbers: please refer to the presentation.

General information: for information about PR activities and engagement at events please refer to the presentation

12.2 Centexbel

OEKO-TEX® numbers: please refer to the presentation.

General information:

Pol Lombaert joined Centexbel as new CEO

Investment in new equipment is in final stage

For information about marketing activities please refer to the presentation

12.3 CENTROCOT

OEKO-TEX® numbers: please refer to the presentation

General information:

Have a new premise for recycling laboratory services.

Enhanced engagement with ZDHC on wastewater testing and ClearStream and has become accredited ZDHC Supplier to Zero Reviewer.

Working towards the acknowledgement of OEKO-TEX® STeP and RESPONSIBLE BUSINESS for the national harmonized checklist for the auditing process that will be signed by brands and implemented throughout their supply chain, as required by the protocol.

For information about business opportunities marketing activities please refer to the presentation.

Challenges:

Several companies prefer compliance with ZDHC and work with other providers as they are less expensive than OEKO-TEX® ECO PASSPORT.

Customers want to use new standard GRTS of the Global Standard organisation.

Suggestions, questions, comments:

Ask for certification solution for recycled materials

Ask for recognition of OKEO-TEX® STeP at Supplier to Zero 2.0

12.4 Citeve

OEKO-TEX® numbers: please refer to the presentation

General information:

Intense R&D activities with strict link to OEKO-TEX® purposes including bio economy, water close loop, fibre and material tracing as well as transparency and DPP

For information about marketing activities please refer to the presentation

Challenges:

Brand demand for OEKO-TEX® STeP and MADE IN GREEN is not enough

Solve problem of too large OKEO-TEX® STADARD 100 scopes

Find solution for OEKO-TEX® STeP for smaller companies, as too high burdens for SMEs

Link the current model of OEKO-TEX® certifications, especially for products such as OEKO-TEX® STANDARD 100 to circularity

Uncertainty about relevance of OEKO-TEX® RESPONSIBLE BUSINESS without accreditation at ISO 17065, consider audit carried out by a recognized global auditing company, like Deloitte, KPMG, to assess functioning and independence of the standard

Internal Methods Accreditation under ISO 17025, not feasible for CITEVE, due to Portuguese Accreditation Body requirements (IPAC)

Opportunities:

Development of OEKO-TEX® MADE IN GREEN as the flag product

Advertisement of OEKO-TEX® STeP as an excellent system for facility process improvement

Require urgent development of digital processes

Improve direct communication between OEKO-TEX® and companies, boosting the OEKO-TEX® community.

12.5 DTI

OEKO-TEX® numbers: please refer to the presentation

General information:

Increasing number of employers for OEKO-TEX® business in 2026
Physical laboratory in construction and expected to be up and running beginning of 2026
Work on getting approval of organic laboratory for OEKO-TEX® ORGANIC COTTON testing in 2026
For information about marketing activities please refer to the presentation

Challenges:

Challenging that not all OEKO-TEX® ORGANIC COTTON customers are visible in the buying guide
OEKO-TEX® MADE IN GREEN is resource intense for institutes employees

Suggestions, questions, comments:

DPP is a key topic that OEKO-TEX® should investigate in

12.6 DTNW

OEKO-TEX® numbers: please refer to the presentation

General information:

Successful accreditation audit at Dakks to DIN EN ISO/IEC 17025 end of 2024
Implementation of restructured testing procedures
Integration of about 75 new updated or completely new OEKO-TEX® testing methods
Acquisition of new customers in the PSA and military sector

Challenges:

Customers phase high uncertainties around the PFAS topic
Difficulties to convince customers to move away from GOTS to OEKO-TEX® ORGANIC COTTON

Suggestions, questions, comments:

More support for customers with regulatory changes

12.7 FILK

OEKO-TEX® numbers: please refer to the presentation

General information:

Generally stable situation at FILK even with uncertainties in the leather market

For information about the leather industry, marketing activities as well as an update on the leather traceability pilot please refer to the presentation

Suggestions, questions, comments:

Suggestion to use timing in which LWG is phasing challenges to get more active in the leather market

Tanneries are generally interested in OEKO-TEX® LEATHER STANDARD certification, but need more brand influence towards the manufacturers, LWG is well established at the brands

GC: Are there chances to collaborate with LWG?

- HS see potential to collaborate and work on acknowledgement, but also the OEKO-TEX® strength to compete against them

12.8 HOHENSTEIN

OEKO-TEX® numbers: please refer to the presentation

General information:

For information about textile market trends, proposals and marketing activities please refer to the presentation

Challenges:

ZDHC has been enabler for OEKO-TEX® ECO PASSPORT, but have less trust towards the organisation

Suggestions, questions, comments:

Regard DPP as a relevant business field
Compliance with labelling regulations is relevant

12.9IFTH

OEKO-TEX® numbers: please refer to the presentation

General information:

Have a new CEO, Arnaud Reytand, since July 15 2025

Working on their facilities and investing in people

Contribution to the French Physical Durability Standard and the National Body Measurement Campaign

For information about French law, marketing activities, best practices and success stories please refer to the presentation

Challenges:

Costs are too high for OEKO-TEX® STeP, customers need to follow too many certifications

Need clear positioning on PFAS

Suggestions, questions, comments:

What is the position of OEKO-TEX® in environmental scoring in France?

Encourage the accessibility of OEKO-TEX® MADE IN GREEN

12.10 INNOVATEXT

OEKO-TEX® numbers: please refer to the presentation

General information:

For an update about the Hungarian industry and marketing activities please refer to the presentation

Suggestions, questions, comments:

Finding solutions to reduce certificate burdens for smaller companies

Promote OEKO-TEX® towards PPE companies

12.11 Lukasiewicz-LIT

OEKO-TEX® numbers: please refer to the presentation

General information: for information about marketing activities please refer to the presentation

12.12 Mirtec

OEKO-TEX® numbers: please refer to the presentation

General information: for information about marketing activities please refer to the presentation

12.13 Nissenken

OEKO-TEX® numbers: please refer to the presentation

General information:

New president Takeshi Ando appointed in June 2025

Expansion of ISO 17025 scope as well as testing lab expansion

For information about marketing and sales activities please refer to the presentation

12.14 OETI

OEKO-TEX® numbers: please refer to the presentation

General information:

Matthias Schwetzel, already registered as managing direct, will take over operations from December 2025 onwards

For information about marketing activities please refer to the presentation

Challenges:

Support greenwashing through current certification system on recycled materials

Suggestions, questions, comments:

Introduce a minimum administration fee for all orders, in case of new certificates based on existing certificates this fee should be used to recover the time for investigating, if a business relation exists between the base certificate holder and the applicant

12.15 RISE

OEKO-TEX® numbers: please refer to the presentation

General information:

For information about marketing activities please refer to the presentation

Challenges:

Time consuming for clients in institute to work with OEKO-TEX® MADE IN GREEN dashboard

Require information on how OEKO-TEX® STANDARD 100 comply with other regulations

Digitalisation needs to accelerate

Suggestions, questions, comments:

OEKO-TEX® needs a response to worldwide AI developments

Promote OEKO-TEX® STANDARD 100 in the hygiene sector

Enhance market interest in OEKO-TEX® STeP certifications

Promote OEKO-TEX® STeP certifications for laundries

Promote OEKO-TEX® ECO PASSPORT regarding consumer products such as special detergents and DWR products

12.16 SHIRLEY

OEKO-TEX® numbers: please refer to the presentation

General information:

For information about marketing activities please refer to the presentation

Forging connections and partnerships with UK brands

Stopped promoting of OEKO-TEX® RESPONSIBLE BUSINESS, B Corp is leading the market

Challenges:

Challenge to communicate about changes towards customers next year

People recruiting is much more challenging

Tax rises and no government support impact customer demand negatively

Suggestions, questions, comments:

OEKO-TEX® needs a response to worldwide AI developments

12.17 STFI

OEKO-TEX® numbers: please refer to the presentation

General information:

Continuous renewal and expansion of testing equipment

For information about the institute please refer to the presentation

12.18 TESTEX

OEKO-TEX® numbers: please refer to the presentation

General information:

For information about marketing activities and stakeholder engagement please refer to presentation

Challenges:

Erosion of the testing base due to more base certificates

Speed of digital system development is critically slow

13 Technical Updates for 2026

Please see the presentation slide 41 -60 for details.

In the following only the results are documented.

Most proposals accepted before the meeting via a forms survey. Only proposals that are not accepted through the survey were discussed in the meeting.

Total fluorine:

GC(Italy): Italian brands request no PFAS and they are not interested in origin and reason. More explanation is needed.

SDr: AFIRM restricts organic fluorine and not total fluorine
GC: prepare a communication for the customers.

SDr: During the dying process the reaction happens (reactive dyes) and the fluorine is cleaved off, we might find it in ECO PASSPORT but not at a later stage (e.g. dyeing process).

SDr: Mention on the certificate: source of fluorine etc. Follow AFIRM exemptions based on functional use (e.g. –PPE, outerwear)

Agreement

Approved if the USA definition of PFAS is included.

Mention of TF source on the certificate.

2nd tier supplier:

LP: wants to encourage but not to force their tier 2 suppliers to approve this.

Agreement

Approved

Certification of wet processes:

Agreement

Approved

New product Classes:

SDr: Naming improvement suggestion: Direct and close to skin? or (e.g jackets etc.)

SDr: Messaging opportunity - e.g. simplify your life, make STANDARD 100 better understandable.

Timeline comment: is 3 months enough for your customer or earlier, IB will work on the communication plan in November in marketing working group

SDo: a faster communication than in March is preferred

JPH: IT connected to the launch – June 2026.

JPH: Base certificate. With old setup and new system for customers.

Agreement

Approved

14 Quality Management

Please see presentation slides 58 - 112

14.1 Control Test

Some additional comments to the slides:

- Please submit only the reports requested.
- The self-control rate remained stable. Some institutes asked for a KPI on the required number of self-controls; for now, this remains at each institute's discretion.
- MADE IN GREEN failure rates have risen to 70% — the highest ever. Most failures are non-chemical and reflect systemic issues (see slide 68 for top reasons).
    - AB: Proposes moving from open scopes to automated or more regulated scopes (e.g., pull-down menus) to improve quality, comparability, and reduce manual work.
- For next year's control tests: please note the corrected LEATHER STANDARD figures for IFTH and FILK.

14.2Round robin tests

Praise from all the round to QM for the improvement in quality through their newly implemented measures.

14.3Core methods

We will discuss directly with the institutes that have issues with the accreditation of core methods.

14.4 Certificate reactivation / withdrawal process:

The main problem with the withdrawal is that it is not possible to know why and how many certificates are withdrawn. Only information about the re-activated certificates is available. Biggest share of reactivated certificates from Hohenstein

STANDARD 100 WG will be discussing the certificate withdrawal again (suspension vs. withdrawal).

SDo: It is difficult to withdraw when the client is already working with their supplier (maybe even finished) to rectify the problem.

SDr: We can review if the risk parameters are the right ones or not, but the ones used today are because they are legally regulated and thus suspension is not enough, we need to withdraw immediately. We sometimes use the control samples for laboratory buffer (depending on the lab capacities) so delays can happen.

ER: The problem with big delays is that the articles are then not in shop anymore and then no consequence or real discussion with the owner of the failed certificate are difficult.

14.5Fair play rules

Institutes can always issue a complaint about fair-play rules using the complaint form (guideline in the intranet /general-documents/OEKO-TEX Association/Quality Management/Complaint form). However, those cases are often difficult to prove, nonetheless everything is set into action to find evidence of fair play or not.

14.6Unannounced On-Site Visits

A discussion about unannounced OSV was held. This are the key points:

- Unannounced audits should be done by an independent OEKO-TEX® audit team with a clear mandate and should not compete with testing (SDr).
- It makes little sense to send the same auditor twice (JPH); unannounced audits help detect client fraud and serve as internal auditor control (SDr).
- Some audits are already done by other institutes without issues (SDo), other institutes report internal pushback (SDr).
- Audit pricing should be revisited, possibly using man-days (JPH).
- The scope of STANDARD 100 audits needs to increase beyond minimal checks to add value (ER).

Alternative funding proposal for unannounced audits “Lower reimbursement to institutes” **- Agreement**

Unannounced audits will be performed as of next business year by the institutes - **Agreement**

Mandate from the general managers: assess the feasibility of creating an independent OEKO-TEX® audit team operating at an international level.

15 Business development initiatives

15.1 New technical meeting concept

Please see presentation slide 120 - 125

How can a new concept be more interactive to encourage information sharing and networking?

GC: This will need a lot of people, please keep this in mind.

IB The concept is different – we need to stop thinking about the product silos and think more in topics.

KS: It is very important that the step of the summary key topics is done correctly, so that information is not lost.

BC: For the structure proposed on slide 125 we need to send too many people. Suggestion: Not too many groups in parallel.

SDo: If we need to send 6 people, then we will send 6 people. But we need to know in advance to know who to send.

JR: Will the many decisions that are currently made in the technical meeting be done in advance digitally? And the goal is not to send more people, but how do we make sure that we send the correct people?

IB: This is not necessary a decision meeting, more a discussion meeting. Like the GM we want to modernize the TM and move away from discussion of individual limit values.

LP: Is it possible to do some workshops also digitally?

LÖ: Six workshops parallel is too much.

IB: We will keep this in mind.

SDr: We need to make sure that the TM is generating value and that it is not just a vacation trip.

Agreement:
The proposal for the new format of the Technical Meeting was accepted. Focus topics to be discussed during the meeting needs to be shared asap / early 2026 so institute employees and plan accordingly.

15.2 Guidebook Webinar

Please see presentation slide 128 - 130

GC: Praise for FR good work.

15.3 ORGANIC COTTON

Please see presentation slide 130 - 140

GC: If we push these labels we need to know the names of the certified pre-suppliers. There is information missing for the downstream user. If they are searching currently, they find mainly GOTS, not ORGANIC COTTON.

VB: GOTS is certifying 4 questions (fiber, not dangerous chemicals in the process, no negative impact, social ok) so we need to improve ORGANIC COTTON to offer something easier than GOTS, but in combination with STeP, to also increase MADE IN GREEN. STeP is too complicated – we need to be critical with our own product and need to simplify STeP.

DG: We did the benchmark between GOTS and ORGANIC COTTON and we need to improve our ORGANIC COTTON to be better.

15.4 Traceability improvement

Please see presentation slide 141 – 150

Proposal for double accounting / labelling risk management via, standard update and OSV update.
SDr : But isn't the only way out to exchange data with GOTS?
DG: Not really,
SDr: Our target should be to include GOTS and ORGANIC COTTON in mass balances
DG: Yes, this will take a longer time, and we need to mitigate the risks in between.
SDr: it is a fast evolving developing standard that have been a communication breakdown – please make sure that there is a more regular and open communication to avoid this through the institutes. It is a really big challenge.

15.5 STeP

Please see presentation slide 155 – 170

Proposal to move ahead with tiered pricing proposal:
SDo: We should move ahead, but does it also mean that we will have a tiered standard?
RL: There are two aspects: do we want to reduce STeP to the bones or do we want to reduce the quality of STeP?
DG: the idea is to address the risks that are applicable to the company
RL: So, we will make modules skippable?
AB: No, but we want to make step more accessible and use the other certificate in the market
SDr: but we need to be clear on the message of the STeP. But how to grouping them is critical
AB: Yes, and we need to be able to group that. And we need to be open to accept other
MS: we just need to make sure that they really are a micro company.
DG: Yes, we will need to make sure of that.
JR: I like that we want to adapt it to the size of the company, we should also look at regions. But we should not lower the level of quality.

SDr: I want us to be careful with the acceptance of other standards
AB: yes, but please conceptualize it.
BC: As STeP is the basis of MADE IN GREEN we need to improve the number of companies for it to work, so we need to think about a political proof to be the system models, don't lower the level of quality, but we need to involve more companies.
HS: accepting separate companies is mainly a factor for bigger companies.

Agreement:
Proposal to conceptualize: ACCEPTED

15.6 Reporting enabler

Please see presentation slide 155 – 170

BC: I think we are not taking about brands, but also about other big companies. In the last meeting I suggested to include a chapter which they can include in their report. We should look into an automatic report that companies can use for the taxonomy.
DG: Yes, that would be great.
GC: I think STeP covers 70% of the content, but not the important data points. We had one company to for which we had to re-calculate the data for the report as there is no data inside.
AB: This is an issue of the legacy system.
BC: Can we not give a QR code for the bank to access the information?
AB: Yes, we become more digital.

15.7 MADE IN GREEN

Please see presentation slide 180-190

15.8 STANDARD UPDATE CYCLE

Please see presentation slide Slide 191

Agreement:
Standard update cycle Proposal accepted:
STANDARD 100, LEATHER, ORGANIC COTTON, ECO-PASSPORT – once a year
STeP and MADE IN GREEN – once in 2 years.

IB: To be clear, there will not be a new standard communication in January. It will be in March, enforced in June.
SDr: Is there a communication for the customer?
CB: Yes, communication is necessary
IB: We will send out a communication that is customer facing about this to all institutes by end of November.

15.9 Stakeholder Management

Please see presentation slide 198 – 215

SDr and VB praise CF for her great and professional presence in the market

15.10 Marketing & Communication

Please see presentation slide 217 - 256

Brand awareness study slide 232
JR: Does this provide a complete picture or is there a bias?
IB: there is a bias, we were asking specifically already conscience consumers
SDr: Is there information on the area of India?
IB: No

GC: Where can see and find MADE IN GREEN and STANARD 100 labeled products in Stores?
IB: I will contact you.

Slide 246:
Proposal for new OEKO-TEX® Claim – ACCEPTED
LP: will it be translated?
IB: Not clear yet
JG: Why not both having two claims?
IB: We want to keep a single, strong message

16 Strategic Steps going forward

Please see presentation slides 257 - 261

1. How do you see the role of OEKO-TEX® evolving with changing regulation.

    - OEKO-TEX® as an Information aggregator:
      Splitting the silos of our standard from a data perspective. Learn from our data and analyse, e.g. hot spot regions The goal must be to have the ability to interact with our data.

      AB: logic needs to create to find patterns in the data
      SDr. This is not immediate action but should be a midterm outlook

    - Cooperation partner:
      Intensive and proof more potential partnerships

2. How do you define the role of the standard setter versus the institutes? What should be the role of the OEKO-TEX Service GmbH?

    - Rule setter / coordinator / consensus generator

    - Brand ambassador: stronger than ZDHC
      Role of an OEKO-TEX® brand ambassador: build a community and engage as OEKO-TEX®
      OEKO-TEX® office in Zurich should approach brands
      We need to work with existing brands and approach new brands as OEKO-TEX® / from the OEKO-TEX® office
      SDo: Coordination of the effort is needed. Communication is needed towards the institutes
      AB: Our strong unique selling point is: OEKO-TEX® as standard setter plus strong certification bodies
      AB: D Next steps: define a list of the preferred 500 brands done by OEKO-TEX® and approach the brands with the question what they need and expect form OEKO-TEX®

      Define a Brand Ambassador versus a Key Account Manager.
      SDo: OEKO-TEX® shouldn't manage the accounts in all details

      CF: Brands value direct contact with OEKO-TEX®

      Agreement:
      Top level strategic discussion with Brands handled by OEKO-TEX®

      Follow up: Organise a global OEKO-TEX brand® summit

3. Where do you see the biggest opportunities for stronger collaboration across institutes?

    - MADE IN GREEN helps us to push ORAGNIC COTTON and recycled.

17 Various

The next General Manager meeting will be held on the 28th – 30th October 2026 in Lyon, France, organised by IFTH.

AB thanks the General Managers for the fruitful discussions and closes the meeting.

The meeting was closed, 31st October 3:30 pm.